

Centre des opérations d'urgences de sante publique « COUSP-RDC »

Situation Report of the 17th Ebola Virus Disease Outbreak / DRC

SitRep N° 008/MVB_23/2026

Provinces affected (3)	ITURI, NORTH KIVU, SOUTH KIVU
Affected Health Zones (11)	ITURI : Aru, Bunia, Kilo, Mongbwalu, Nizi, Nyankunde and Rwampara NORTH KIVU : Butembo, Goma and Katwa SOUTH KIVU : Miti-Murhesa
Reporting date	May 22, 2026
Publication date	May 23, 2026

							
91	10	867	ND	ND	ND	0	16
Total confirmed cases	Total deaths among confirmed cases	Cumulative cases suspects	Cumulative probable cases	Occupancy rate among suspects	Occupancy rate among experienced staff	Healed	Cumulative confirmed cases of CTE

Table I. Distribution of confirmed cases and deaths by health zone in the affected provinces

Provinces touched	Health zones with case confirmed	New case confirmed	New deaths among confirmed	New case probable	New case suspects	New contacts listed	Cured of day
Ituri	Bunia	6	1	ND	32	87	0
	Rwampara	7	1	ND	14	0	0
	Mongbwalu	1	0	ND	10	0	0
	Bamboo	0	0	ND	2	48	0
	Nyankunde	2	0	ND	9	207	0
	Nizi	1	0	ND	1	ND	0
	Kilo	1	0	ND	1	ND	0
Subtotal		18	2	0	70	342	0
North Kivu	Goma	0	0	ND	ND	ND	0
	Butembo	0	0	ND	ND	ND	0
	Katwa	0	0	ND	ND	ND	0
South Kivu	Miti Murhesa	1	1	ND	ND	ND	0
Subtotal		1	1	0	0	0	0
Total		19	3	0	70	342	0



Presentation of the preparedness and response plan for the 17th Ebola Virus Disease epidemic on May 21, 2026 at COUSP, with the Director General of the National Institute of Public Health.



Visit of the DG of Africa CDC to Bunia, Province of Ituri (Meeting with the governor and other partners)

I. CONTEXT

Ituri Province is located in the northeast of the Democratic Republic of Congo and shares a long border with Uganda and South Sudan. For more than two decades, it has faced a chronic humanitarian crisis linked to armed conflict and recurring population displacements. It has an estimated population of over 8 million, including more than one million internally displaced persons.

In September 2018, this province was affected by an Ebola virus disease epidemic that was raging in the neighbouring province of North Kivu.

The Mongbwalu health zone is one of the 36 health zones in the Ituri province.

Considered the starting point of the epidemic, it is located in the Djugu territory, where several armed groups operate. It is situated 70 km from Bunia, the capital of Ituri province, with frequent population movements towards Uganda. This locality is characterized by several construction sites that attract people from other territories within the province and from neighboring provinces.

II. HISTORY OF THE EPIDEMIC

On May 5, 2026, social media reported a surge in deaths of unknown cause, with nearly 50 deaths already recorded in the Mongbwalu health zone. Following confirmation of this alert, the Chief Medical Officer of the Mongbwalu health zone shared the preliminary investigation report on May 9, 2026. On May 11, 2026, provincial health authorities held an emergency meeting and decided to deploy rapid response teams to Mongbwalu and Rwampara, which had reported suspected deaths from viral hemorrhagic fever among patients hospitalized at the Rwampara Evangelical Medical Center, who had been transferred from Mongbwalu.

Investigations conducted on May 12, 2026, simultaneously in the Mongbwalu and Rwampara health zones by the Rapid Intervention Teams of the Ituri Provincial Health Division (DPS), revealed that most of the patients or suspected deaths presented with fever, headaches, vomiting, and intense physical asthenia. The deaths

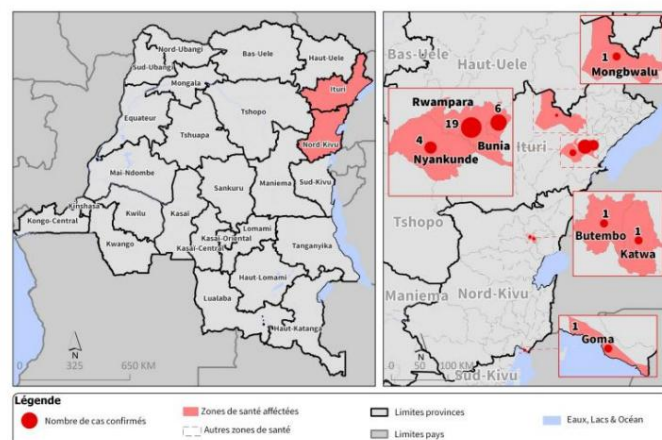
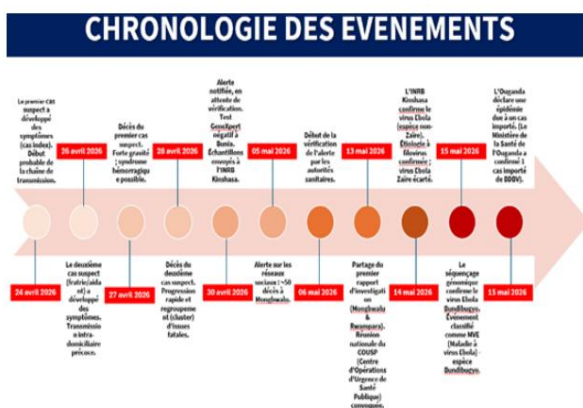
Symptoms appeared 2 to 3 days after the onset of illness, presenting as hematemesis, epistaxis, or blackish vomit. During investigations in the Rwampara health zone, 20 samples were collected from suspected cases or deaths. The majority of samples were taken from the Mongbwalu health zone. Preliminary tests conducted at the Bunia Laboratory were all negative for Ebola Zaire, dengue, rotavirus, cholera, malaria, *Yersinia pestis*, medullary tuberculosis, and COVID-19. These samples were sent to the National Institute of Biomedical Research (INRB) in Kinshasa for further testing.

As of May 14, 2026, **13 of these 20 samples were tested, and 8 were found to be positive** for non-Zairean Ebola virus disease at the INRB in Kinshasa. On May 15, 2026, sequencing of the positive samples identified the BUNDIRUGYO strain, *allowing the Minister of Public Health, Hygiene and Social Welfare (MSHPS) to officially declare the 17th Ebola virus disease outbreak.*

Ebola virus disease (Bundibugyo strain), thus marking the 17th epidemic in the country's history

As of May 17, 2026, in consultation with member states, the WHO Director-General considers that the event taking place in DRC and Uganda meets the criteria of the definition set out in Article 1 of the IHR, and declared that this constitutes a Public Health Emergency of International Concern while specifying that the risk at the global level is low but high at the regional level.

On May 18, 2026, the Executive Director of Africa CDC officially declared a Continental Public Health Emergency (CPHE) under Article 3 of its statutes. This declaration followed an emergency meeting of the Africa CDC Advisory Group, which determined that the worsening outbreak posed an acute risk to continental health security. As a result, the Continental Incident Management Support Team was activated to provide support to affected and at-risk Member States in their response and preparedness efforts.



Les frontières et les noms indiqués et les désignations utilisées sur cette carte n'impliquent l'expression d'aucune opinion que ce soit de la part de l'Organisation Mondiale de la Santé concernant le statut juridique de tout pays, territoire, ville ou région sous son autorité, ni concernant la délimitation de ses frontières ou limites. | Source des données: MSH/WHO | Réalisation: Louise IEM Kimbasa | Copyright: OMS 2020

III. EPIDEMIOLOGICAL SITUATION UPDATE

- 7 New Confirmed Cases (Aru: 1, Bunia: 1, Nyakunde: 1, and Mongbwalu: 2, Butembo: 1 and Katua ;1)
- Cumulative number of confirmed cases in Ituri as of May 22, 2026: 82 cases, North Kivu 5 cases and South Kivu 1 case
- Three provinces affected: ITURI, NORTH KIVU and SOUTH KIVU: • ITURI:
epicenter with 7/36 health zones affected (Rwampara, Bunia, Mongbwalu, Nyankunde, Nizi, Kilo and Aru,)
- NORTH KIVU: 3/35 health zones affected (Goma, Butembo and Katwa)
- SOUTH KIVU: 1/34 ZS hit (Miti-Murhesa)
- Total confirmed cases: 88 cases
- ITURI: 82 cases
- NORTH KIVU: 5 cases
- SOUTH KIVU: 1 case
- Number of new health zones affected: 1 (Aru health zone in Ituri)
- Number of affected health zones in Ituri: 7/36 health zones

IV. RESPONSE ACTIONS

COORDINATION

- A coordination meeting was held, chaired by the Deputy Incident Manager, Head of Division Provincial Health Directorate of North Kivu (Beni) and Ituri (Bunia). •
Holding of the partner mobilization meeting on alignment with the response plan.
- Development of the provincial action plan for the Ebola Virus Disease incident in the Ituri Provincial Health Division and North Kivu.

EPIDEMIOLOGICAL SURVEILLANCE

- Transmission to the coordination of the Terms of Reference for the deployment of multidisciplinary provincial teams in the Mongbwalu Health Zone.
- Transmission to the coordination of TDRs for training stakeholders (ECZS, IT&ITA, agent leads) community and data managers) from five active ZS
- Provision of thermal flashing devices in the Nizi security zones (4)

Table II. Summary of the alert status as of May 21, 2026

Health zones	Report for alerts alerts (21/05)	News (22/05)	Total alerts from the day (22/05)	Alerts the living	Alerts deceased	Alerts investigated	No alerts investigated	Alerts validated	Alerts invalidated	Case suspects samples taken	Case suspects No samples taken	Case suspects isolated	Case suspects No isolated
Bunia	4	28	32	28	4	32	0	32	0	15	17	28	0
Rwampara 12		10	22	16	6	15	7	14	8	14	8	8	8
Nyankunde 0		9	9	7	2	7	2	9	0	4	5	6	1
Mongbwalu 0		11	11	7	4	7	4	10	1	8	3	7	0
Nizi	0	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0
Aru	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Kilo	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Bamboo	0	2	2	2	0	2	0	2	0	1	1	0	2
Adi	0	5	5	5	0	5	0	5	0	5	0	5	0
Lita	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Fataki	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Logo	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Aungba	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Rethy	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Komanda	0	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0
Nyarambe ND		ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Tchomia	0	1	1	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	0
Drodoro	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Mambassa ND		ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Mangala	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Lolwa	ND	ND	ND	ND ND		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Total	16	68	84	68	16	71	13	75	9	50	34	57	11

Table III. Summary of contact identification and follow-up as of May 22, 2026

Areas of health	Daily monitoring						tracking	Total	Reason for not being seen							the
	Postponed from	New	day Contact	Contacts	Releases	They			Simple	Lost	hours) Never	Refusal	Displaced	pass Reco		
Bunia	290	71	361	71	0	10	20%	290	0	0	0	0	0	290	361	
Rwampara	621	ND	621	ND	ND	ND	0%	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	621	
Nyankunde	340	25	365	234	0	1	64%	131	99		1	0	0	0	31	365
Mongbwalu	176	46	222	46	0	2	21%	176		0	0	0	0	0	176	222
Kilo	176	ND	176	ND		ND	ND	0%	176	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	176
Aru	ND	ND	ND	ND		ND	ND			ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	
Nizi	ND	ND	ND	ND		ND	ND			ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	

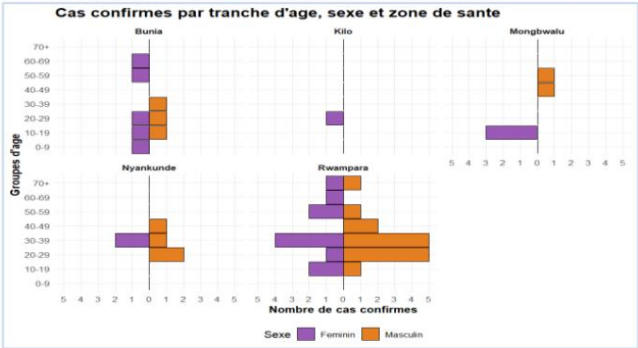
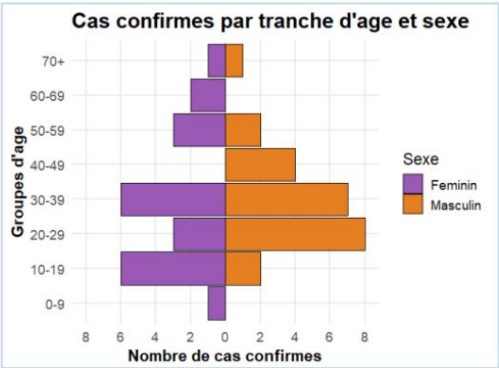
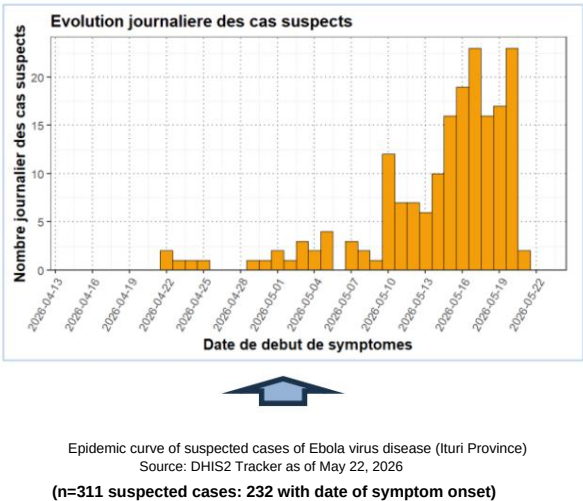
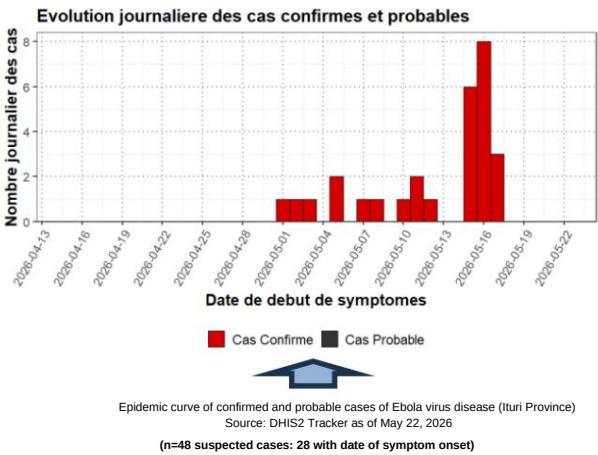
Total	1603	142	1745	351		0	13	20%	1394	99		1	0	0	0	1294	1745	
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Table IV. Distribution of suspected and confirmed Ebola virus disease cases, deaths in the health zones of the Ituri, North Kivu and South Kivu health districts as of May 22, 2026*

Provinces	Health zones	Number of cases suspects	Number of probable deaths**	Number of cases Confirmed	Number of contacts
Ituri	Mongbwalu	339	88	10	222
	Rwampara	221	63	32	621
	Bunia	227	42	23	290
	Nyankunde	45	8	9	365
	Kilo	6	2	1	176
	Nizi	5	1	2	0
	ARU	3	0	1	0
	Samples without a datasheet	0	0	6	0
North Kivu	Goma	ND	0	1	ND
	Katwa	13	0	3	ND
	Butembo	7	0	2	ND
South Kivu	Miti Murhesa	1	0	1	ND
Total		867	204	91	1674

*This data is subject to change after harmonization of data at different levels of the health pyramid with the incident management system.
** The classification will be confirmed after further investigation.

Figure 1. Evolution of confirmed cases in the Ituri DPS



by date of symptom onset (source: DHIS2 Partial Tracker)

Point of Entry and Point of Control (PoE/PoC) Surveillance

- Participation of the Provincial Coordinating Physician of the PNHF in Ituri and the National Director of the PNHF in the preparatory meeting to strengthen cross-border collaboration between the DRC and Uganda in the response to the Ebola Ebola epidemic
- Acceptance by the Lake Albert Transport Associations (ATLA) and travel agencies for the disinfection of speedboats and vehicles

Table V. Data Summary (PoE/PoC) of 22/05/2026

Health Zone	PoE/PoC	Tot v past	Tot v screené s	Total hand washing	Tot v sensibilis ed	All alerts	Total refusal Handwashing	Tot refus screenin g
NIZI	NIZI BRIDGE	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
BUNIA	AIRPORT	1332	1332	1332	1332	0		0
	MUDZIBALA	2028	1924	1924	2028	0	0 104	104
	BRIDGE SIMBILIABO	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
RWAMPARA SHARI	BRIDGE	1800	1739	1739	1800	0	61	61
	DELE	1109	1057	52	1109	0	52	52
	CHAI	243	200	200	243	0	43	43
TCHOMIA	TCHOMIA					0		0
	NYAMUSASI	0 167	0 148	0 148	0 167	0	0 19	19
	KASENYI	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	MANDJE	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
NYAKUNDE MARABO		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	NYAK ENTRANCE.	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	SOTA	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	TALOLO BRIDGE	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
MONGBWALU POIPO		ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	MAHIDEDE	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	PLITO BRIDGE	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
	KIRIKOU BRIDGE	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
ARU	OFOO	392	358	358	392	0	34	34
	ODHUMONI	317	289	289	317	0	28	28
	OMBAYI	175	152	152	175	0	23	23

	NO COMPLAINT	121	103	103	121	0	18	18
	VIS À VIS	87	71	71	87	0	16	16
	KENZEZI-BASE	51	37	37	51	0	14	14

LABORATORY

Total	
Total samples received	342
Re-sampling (control) 3	
Total samples analyzed	189
Cumulative positives	91

DISTRIBUTION OF SAMPLES TESTED AT THE BUNIA PAR NATURE LAB

Date	Provenance / ZS	Nombre échantillons testés	Natures d'échantillon		Représentation	Positifs		Négatifs		Indéterminés	
			Sang	Swab		Sang	Swab	Sang	Swab	Sang	Swab
22/05/2026	Aru	3	3	0	0	1	0	2	0	0	0
	Aungba	1	1	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
	Bunia	2	2	0	0	1	0	1	0	0	0
	Nyakunde	2	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
	Mongbwalu	5	5	0	0	2	0	1	0	2	0
	Rwampara	4	4	0	0	0	0	4	0	0	0
	Mangala	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
TOTAL		18	17	1	0	4	1	9	0	2	0

DISTRIBUTION OF SAMPLES TAKEN

Date	Origin S	it reveals ent	Diagnostic						Follow up	
			results P			results P			results P at P	
			Positive	Negative	Positive	Negative	Positive	Negative		
	Aru									
	Aun a									
	Bunia									
	N a unde									
	on aluminum									
	a macaw									
	an ala									

RISK COMMUNICATION AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT (RCCE)

- Advocacy efforts with the mayors of the municipalities of Shari, Nyakasanza, and Mbunya to secure their commitment to supporting communication activities related to the Ebola response.
- Briefing of 19 department heads operating at Bunia airport, including 15 men and 4 women, on the Ebola virus disease and prevention measures in public areas
- Awareness-raising of 38 livestock farmers and wholesale traders at the Bunia industrial slaughterhouse on preventive measures against Ebola virus disease, including 16 women and 22 men.
- Educational talk with 30 women during a CPS session on preventive measures to MVE, ZS Bunia, AS BIGO

INFECTION PREVENTION AND CONTROL

ZS Bunia

3 EDS carried out (HGR-Bunia, Rwankole, Bunia-Cite) out of 4 alert cases;

• Briefing of healthcare providers in the 2 ESS (CSR Bunia-cité and Clinique Universelle) on Waste Management;

• Briefing of 3 teams (ZS Bunia and ZS Rwampara) on dignified and safe burial (EDS);

• Briefing of 9 service providers by EMIR on triage and isolation, waste management, active research in the social and solidarity economy (SSE), and injection safety

ZS Rwampara

• Briefing of 20 service providers on the wearing and removal of PPE, waste disposal, decontamination , there and hand washing (HGR-Rwampara).

• Decontamination of surfaces at CME Nyakunde, intensive care unit at HGR Rwampara and the room isolation.

• 3 EDS carried out on 4 alert cases (1 body recovered by the family);

• Decontamination in 20 households around the case.

ZS Mongbwalu

- Decontamination of the ambulance at HGR MONGBWALU.

- Immediate briefing of 36 hygiene specialists (with support from technical and financial partners) on the wearing and removal of PPE

ZS NYAKUNDE

- Decontamination of a household in MARABO and interning IEM Nyakunde.

DPS North Kivu

- Decontamination of Matanda Hospital where the confirmed case from the Katwa health zone is staying;

- Matanda Hospital PCI scorecard evaluation: 70.6%; • Case mapping completed;

- Status of the CTE for the release of PCI input needs (PPE, water supply, waste management, patient circuit).

LOGISTICS

• Delivery of inputs and protective equipment to laboratory and IPC pillars for 4 category 1 ESS (Bunia General Referral Hospital, Rwampara General Referral Hospital, SALAMA Hospital and CME Hospital)

• Delivery of inputs and protective equipment to the LITA ZS for EDS

• Unpacking of inputs and equipment received as of May 21, 2026

• Monitoring of the installation of treatment tents at Bunia General Referral Hospital (ALIMA and WHO) and the installation of the Ebola Treatment Center (ETC) in Mongbwalu by MSF

HOLISTIC CARE

- Briefing of service providers at HGR Bunia and Rwampara on the wearing of PPE;

- Clinical evaluation of patients;

- Delivery of 5 mattresses, 5 beds and other equipment to the CME

- Finalizing the expression of needs with PAM.

- Clinical evaluation of patients;

- Immediate briefing of 10 service providers on the PEC;

- Monitoring the assembly of two isolation tents at the Bunia General Referral Hospital, one of which is ready and the other is in progress;

Continued development of the CME building

- Announcement: 9 negative cases (including 3 PPL); 5 positive cases;
- Active listening: 2 confirmed cases;
- Counseling: 9 negative cases awaiting sample collection;
- Individual interview: 1 orphan; •
- Psychoeducation: 2 confirmed cases;

Table VI. Patient movement in healthcare facilities as of [date]**22/05/2026**

Indicators		ZS Bunia	ZS Rwampara	ZS MONGBWALU	ZS NYANKUNDE	TOTAL GENERAL
Report (Number of patients in bed at the end of the previous day)		33	34	30	22	119
News Today's admissions	PPL	3	1	0	1	5
	Others	8	10	4	1	23
	Total new admissions for today	11	11	4	2	28
Total number in isolation: 44			45	34	24	147

SECURITY

- The security situation in the city of Bunia (Bunia and Rwampara health zones) is relatively calm
- Security briefing for deployed teams.

V. CHALLENGES

- Absence of standardized CT and CTE
- Shortages of IPC equipment (PPE, DLM, chlorine) in North Kivu
- Poor reporting of alerts by zones; • Delay in sample collection;
- Lack of nutritional support;
- Absence of psycho-social interventions in Mongbwalu;
- Delay in the development of isolation sites.

VI. Recommendation

- Make the CT and CTE facilities in Beni, Butembo and Goma operational (rehabilitation and circuit revision)
- Strengthen surveillance to facilitate the reporting of alerts and the tracing of contacts never seen and lost sight of;
- Mobilize resources to support the different pillars of the response;
- Training of service providers on Ebola virus disease (EVD) and squamous cell carcinoma (SCC) surveillance in affected and high-risk health zones risk ;
- Training of Community Health Workers on Ebola and SBC Surveillance in Affected Health Zones and high risk.

PHOTOS

- Briefing des équipes de laboratoire sur l'utilisation de DHIS2;
- Poursuite d'encodage des données dans les ZS Bunia et Rwampara



Surface decontamination /CME Nyakunde (ZS Rwampara)

Tent assembly work continues



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